

DLSU Faculty Pre-boarding Process Guide

This guide describes the sequence of steps a candidate for a DLSU faculty position walks through between receiving a conditional job offer and reporting for their first day of classes. It is a supplementary, process-focused companion to the DLSU Faculty Manual 2021, which states hiring criteria and the general hiring procedure (see Faculty Manual, Hiring Procedure, p.24, and the per-rank Criteria for Hiring, pp.16-23) but does not itself lay out the week-by-week pre-boarding workflow. Where this guide and the Faculty Manual overlap, the Faculty Manual is the controlling document for hiring criteria and academic policy; this guide is controlling for process, timing, and document routing.

Scope note: this document covers Full-time Academic Faculty, Part-time Academic Faculty, and Academic Service Faculty (ASF). Each track has a different pre-boarding path; see §3 for a class-by-class breakdown. If your appointment type is unclear, ask your Department Chair before assuming any single track applies to you.

1. The Six Stages of Pre-boarding

Pre-boarding at DLSU runs through six stages, from initial screening to first-day orientation. The stages are the same in sequence across faculty classes; what differs is which documents are required and how much lead time each stage takes (§3).

Stage	What happens	Typical office of record
1. Screening & shortlisting	Application, credential screening, initial interview with the Department Chair.	Department / College
2. Teaching demonstration & panel interview	Candidate delivers a teaching demonstration and is interviewed by the College hiring panel.	College Dean's Office
3. Conditional job offer	Dean's Office issues a conditional offer contingent on document submission and clearance results.	College Dean's Office / HRMO
4. Document submission & verification	Candidate submits the pre-employment document set (Faculty Manual criteria + statutory documents); HRMO verifies completeness.	HRMO
5. Clearance & contract finalization	Background and government clearances are confirmed; employment contract or appointment paper is signed.	HRMO / Legal Affairs
6. Onboarding orientation & first day	New-hire orientation, ID issuance, systems access, and first day of teaching or service.	HRMO / Department

2. Stage-by-Stage Detail

2.1 Screening and Shortlisting

The Department Chair reviews applications against the per-rank Criteria for Hiring (Faculty Manual pp.16-23), which set minimum educational attainment, relevant experience, and licensure requirements by academic rank (Instructor through Professor). Shortlisted candidates are invited for an initial interview. At this stage candidates are asked to submit a biodata or curriculum vitae and unofficial transcripts only; original documents are not yet required.

2.2 Teaching Demonstration and Panel Interview

Academic-track candidates deliver a teaching demonstration evaluated by a College panel that typically includes the Department Chair, a senior faculty member, and a College Dean's Office representative. Academic Service Faculty (ASF) candidates, who are hired for non-teaching academic-support roles, undergo a competency interview in place of a teaching demonstration; see §3.3. The panel's recommendation feeds directly into the conditional offer decision in Stage 3.

2.3 Conditional Job Offer

The College Dean's Office issues a conditional offer letter specifying rank, load, and start date. The offer is explicitly conditional on (a) submission of a complete document set within the stated deadline, usually 15 working days from the offer date, and (b) clean or acceptable results on the government and previous-employer clearances described in §4. Candidates should not resign from a current position or make relocation commitments before clearance results are confirmed.

2.4 Document Submission and Verification

The candidate submits the full pre-employment document set to HRMO. The complete list of faculty-specific documents (per Faculty Manual hiring criteria) and national statutory documents is maintained separately -- see the companion documents 'DLSU Faculty Pre-employment Requirements' and 'Philippine Statutory Pre-employment Requirements'. HRMO logs each submitted document against a per-candidate checklist and flags missing or defective items back to the candidate, typically within 3 to 5 working days of submission.

A document is treated as 'received' only once HRMO confirms it is the correct type, legible, and complete on its face -- receipt is not the same as validation. Validation (e.g., NBI Clearance freshness, name matching) happens in Stage 5.

2.5 Clearance and Contract Finalization

HRMO confirms that the NBI Clearance shows no derogatory record (a 'hit' requiring further verification triggers a hold, not an automatic rejection -- see the statutory requirements document §1 for how NBI hits are resolved), that the clearance from the candidate's previous employer is on file, and that the physical fitness certification is current. Once all clearances are confirmed, Legal Affairs prepares the employment contract (for full-time and part-time Academic Faculty) or appointment paper (for ASF), which the candidate signs before the start date.

2.6 Onboarding Orientation and First Day

New hires attend a one-day HRMO orientation covering the Faculty Manual's General Functions and academic responsibilities (Faculty Manual §1.1, p.8), the Code of Conduct, benefits enrollment, and campus systems access (email, learning management system, library, ID issuance). Department-level orientation with the Chair -- covering course assignments, syllabus expectations, and consultation scheduling -- follows on or before the first day of classes.

3. Differences by Faculty Class

The Faculty Manual maintains three parallel structures for Full-time Academic Faculty, Part-time Academic Faculty, and Academic Service Faculty, each with its own hiring, leave, and benefits provisions. Pre-boarding timing and document load differ accordingly.

3.1 Full-time Academic Faculty

Full-time candidates undergo the complete six-stage process described in §2, including a teaching demonstration. Because a full-time appointment carries a probationary period governed by the

Faculty Manual, HRMO also opens a probation-tracking record at Stage 5 that runs independently of the pre-boarding checklist.

3.2 Part-time Academic Faculty

Part-time hiring follows the same six stages but on a compressed timeline, reflecting the semester-bound nature of part-time load assignment (Faculty Manual, part-time provisions, p.67). Document submission and clearance (Stages 4-5) are typically compressed into a single combined step, and the conditional-offer window in Stage 3 is shortened to 10 working days given the closer proximity to the start of term. Part-time faculty are not required to complete a full orientation day; a condensed half-day session covering the Code of Conduct and systems access substitutes for it.

3.3 Academic Service Faculty (ASF)

ASF roles (Faculty Manual ASF provisions, p.83) support academic units in non-teaching capacities -- for example laboratory supervision, curriculum support, or academic program coordination. Stage 2 replaces the teaching demonstration with a competency interview relevant to the specific ASF role. Document requirements otherwise mirror full-time Academic Faculty (§3.1).

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Party	Responsibility during pre-boarding
Candidate / New hire	Submits complete, legible documents by the stated deadline; responds to HRMO follow-ups within 3 working days; confirms availability for the start date.
Department Chair	Conducts initial screening and teaching-demonstration evaluation; recommends rank and load; is the candidate's first point of contact for process questions.
College Dean's Office	Issues the conditional offer; approves final rank and start date; signs off on College-level hiring criteria compliance.
HRMO	Owns the master pre-boarding checklist; verifies document completeness; coordinates clearance results; schedules orientation; is the escalation point if a stage stalls.
Legal Affairs	Prepares and finalizes the employment contract or appointment paper once all clearances are confirmed.

5. Indicative Pre-boarding Timeline

The timeline below is indicative for a Full-time Academic Faculty hire starting at the beginning of a term; Part-time timelines compress as noted in §3.2. Working days exclude University holidays.

Day (relative to start date)	Milestone
Day -45 to -30	Screening, teaching demonstration, and panel interview completed.
Day -30	Conditional offer issued; 15-working-day document deadline begins.
Day -30 to -15	Candidate submits documents; HRMO logs and flags gaps.
Day -15 to -10	HRMO confirms document completeness; escalates unresolved gaps to the candidate and Department Chair.
Day -10 to -5	Clearance results confirmed; contract or appointment paper prepared.
Day -5 to -2	Contract signed; HRMO schedules orientation.
Day -1	HRMO orientation and systems access provisioning.
Day 0	First day of classes or service; Department-level orientation with the Chair.

6. Incomplete Documents and Contingent Status

If a candidate cannot complete the document set by the deadline in §2.4, HRMO may grant a contingent start on a case-by-case basis, approved by the Dean's Office, provided that: (a) all faculty-specific Faculty Manual documents are complete, (b) the NBI Clearance has been applied for and a valid application reference is on file even if the clearance itself is pending, and (c) no more than two statutory documents remain outstanding. A contingent start is time-boxed to 30 calendar days; if outstanding documents are not resolved within that window, HRMO refers the case to the Dean's Office for a decision on continued contingent status.

A contingent start is never granted for a missing or unresolved NBI Clearance 'hit' (a positive match requiring further verification) or for a missing physical fitness certification -- these two items must be fully resolved before the first day.

7. Frequently Confused Points

- A conditional offer is not a signed contract -- either party may still withdraw before Stage 5 if clearance results are unacceptable.
- The NBI Clearance's printed validity is one year from issuance, but DLSU applies its own freshness policy for pre-employment purposes; see the statutory requirements document for the exact window used at submission time.
- Orientation (Stage 6) is separate from and does not substitute for the probationary period tracked for full-time faculty -- the two run on independent timelines.
- Part-time faculty follow the same six stages, not a separate, shorter process -- only the timing and orientation format differ (§3.2).

8. Where to Get Help

Process questions (status of a submitted document, timeline, contingent-start eligibility) go to HRMO. Questions about hiring criteria, rank, or teaching load go to the Department Chair or College Dean's Office. Questions about a specific statutory document (where to apply, what an NBI 'hit' means, how to correct a name mismatch) are answered in the companion document 'Philippine Statutory Pre-employment Requirements'.